

1 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Lost-and-found story

What we are practising

Link story events with a clear cause and result.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Tell the story aloud instead of writing it.

Before you begin

Draw three empty boxes on a sheet.

Share fictional details; no personal addresses or names are needed.

Try it together

1. Choose a lost object, such as a red hat.
2. In box one, show who lost it and where.
3. In box two, add a clue; in box three, show how the clue helps find it.
4. Retell the story using first, then and finally.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How did the clue change what the character did?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Describe without naming

What we are practising

Choose descriptive words and ask useful questions.

What you need

No materials

Choose imaginary objects if the room has few examples.

Before you begin

Agree that players will stay in place and choose safe everyday objects.

Do not handle sharp, hot or electrical objects; describe them only if needed.

Try it together

1. Secretly choose an object, such as a spoon.
2. Give three clues about shape, material or use without naming it.
3. Let your partner ask two yes-or-no questions, then guess.
4. Swap roles and discuss which clue helped most.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which clue ruled out the most other objects?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Facts or guesses?

What we are practising

Support a reading answer with evidence from the text.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Read the scene aloud and answer orally.

Before you begin

Write: Lina entered with a wet umbrella. She put it beside the door.

Use a fictional scene; this is about text evidence, not judging real people.

Try it together

1. Read the two sentences twice.
2. Label each statement fact or guess: the umbrella was wet; it was raining outside; Lina put it by the door.
3. Point to words that support each fact.
4. Invent another possible reason for a wet umbrella.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can something be a sensible guess without being stated?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Instructions that work

What we are practising

Give ordered instructions using position and size words.

What you need

Two sheets of paper / Pencils

Trace shapes in the air while the partner describes them back.

Before you begin

Sit so each person's paper is hidden from the other.

Keep feedback about the instructions rather than artistic skill.

Try it together

1. Draw a large circle with a small triangle above it and two dots inside.
2. Describe one part at a time without showing your drawing.
3. Let your partner ask questions, then compare the drawings.
4. Rewrite one unclear instruction and try again.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which missing detail caused the biggest difference?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 15 minutes

Two voices, one event

What we are practising

Distinguish an event from a character's feelings about it.

What you need

Paper / Pencil

Act out both voices without writing.

Before you begin

Choose this event: rain begins during a picnic.

Use imagined situations and allow children to skip any uncomfortable role.

Try it together

1. Describe the rain in one neutral sentence.
2. Speak as a person who wants dry sandwiches.
3. Speak as a nearby gardener pleased about watering plants.
4. Compare what stayed the same and which feelings changed.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Can both characters describe the same event honestly?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Who does “she” mean?

What we are practising

Track a pronoun across two sentences.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“Maha planted a seed. She watered it every morning.” Who does “she” refer to?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The feeling in the clue

What we are practising

Infer a likely feeling from a stated action.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“Before her first stage performance, Leen held her script tightly and whispered, ‘What if I forget?’” Is she probably nervous or bored? Give a clue.

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Connect a cause and result

What we are practising

Choose a causal connector that fits the meaning.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“The plant drooped ____ its soil was dry.” Choose because or although.

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The first word in the list

What we are practising

Order familiar words by their first alphabetic letter.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Use this alphabet order: a, b, c, d. Which word comes first in an alphabetical list: dog, ant, cat or bag?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Which meaning of “light”?

What we are practising

Choose a word meaning using its sentence context.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“This empty bag is light enough to carry easily.” Does light mean not heavy or brightness here?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

The opposite within a sentence

What we are practising

Select an antonym that fits a specific context.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“The path was narrow; only one person could pass.” What opposite of narrow fits: wide or noisy?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Make the owner clear

What we are practising

Identify and repair an unclear possessive reference.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“Omar told Sami that his bike was outside.” Can we be certain whose bike it is? Rewrite to mean Sami’s bike.

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Who said the words?

What we are practising

Distinguish quoted speech from narration.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Lina said, "The gate is open." Which words did Lina say: "Lina said" or "The gate is open"?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

What happened before lunch?

What we are practising

Follow before and after in a short account.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“After drawing, Yara ate lunch. Before drawing, she read.” What did Yara do first?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Make the subject and verb agree

What we are practising

Choose a verb form that agrees with its subject.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Choose the sentence that fits standard English: "The birds sings" or "The birds sing".

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

A heading that fits all three

What we are practising

Choose a heading that covers related details.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A paragraph explains watering plants, giving them suitable light and checking their soil. Which heading fits: “Caring for Plants” or “Kinds of Wheels”?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

A comparison using “like”

What we are practising

Interpret a simple comparison as figurative language.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“The lake was smooth like a mirror.” Does the writer mean the lake is made of glass, or that its surface looks smooth and reflective?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Which detail answers the question?

What we are practising

Select relevant information from a short passage.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“The library opens at nine. Its door is blue. It closes at five.” Which detail answers “When does it open?”

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

An instruction or a description?

What we are practising

Identify a sentence that tells someone what to do.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Which sentence gives an instruction: "Fold the paper once" or "The paper is yellow"?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 7-8 | 10 minutes

Repair the surprising sentence

What we are practising

Use meaning to detect a misplaced action word.

What you need

No materials

Draw the scene or point to imagined choices if speaking is difficult.

Before you begin

An adult reads the whole question; pause to explain unfamiliar words.

An adult is available for unfamiliar vocabulary or checking a calculation; no personal information is needed.

Try it together

1. Read the question below and identify what you need to find.
2. Try an answer; show your thinking with words, fingers or a quick drawing.
3. Use the hint if needed, then compare with the answer and explain why it fits.

Talk, draw or show your idea

“Nour drank her sandwich and ate her water.” Which two words should swap to make an ordinary lunch sentence?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. Lost-and-found story

A little hint

A useful clue might be a photo showing where the hat was left.

Answer / what to notice

Many endings work if the clue genuinely helps find the object.

A connected ending follows from earlier events rather than appearing by chance.

Make it easier

Draw pictures and let an adult write your words.

Take it further

Add a misleading clue and explain why it was unhelpful.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell the same events from the hat's point of view.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. Describe without naming

A little hint

For a spoon, describe a small bowl at the end of a handle.

Answer / what to notice

Accept a guess that fits every clue; refine a clue if several objects fit.

Specific features distinguish an object better than broad words such as nice.

Make it easier

Choose from three visible objects.

Take it further

Describe an object without mentioning its usual use.

Another day, away from the screen

Collect five precise describing words during an ordinary conversation.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Facts or guesses?

A little hint

The text never tells us the weather.

Answer / what to notice

Wet umbrella: fact. Rain outside: guess. Beside the door: fact.

Rain is plausible, but the umbrella could have been washed; evidence limits what we know.

Make it easier

Check only the first two statements.

Take it further

Add a sentence that confirms or disproves the rain guess.

Another day, away from the screen

Find one stated fact and one inference in a story you already own.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. Instructions that work

A little hint

Say whether the triangle touches the circle and where the dots sit.

Answer / what to notice

Drawings need not be identical; improvement means more agreed features match.

A listener needs details that the speaker can see but has not yet described.

Make it easier

Use only a circle and one dot.

Take it further

Give all instructions before the partner starts drawing.

Another day, away from the screen

Write clear instructions for folding a sheet in half, then test them.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Two voices, one event

A little hint

Keep the weather identical but change what each character needs.

Answer / what to notice

Both accounts can fit: rain wets the picnic and also waters the garden.

Different needs can produce different reactions to the same facts.

Make it easier

Choose between happy and disappointed for each character.

Take it further

Add a third character with mixed feelings and explain why.

Another day, away from the screen

Retell a familiar fairy tale from a minor character's viewpoint.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Who does “she” mean?

A little hint

Find the person named before the pronoun.

Answer / what to notice

Maha.

She replaces Maha, while it replaces the seed.

Make it easier

Read the second sentence using Maha instead.

Take it further

What does “it” refer to in the same passage?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. The feeling in the clue

A little hint

What does her question show she is thinking about?

Answer / what to notice

Probably nervous; she worries about forgetting.

The worry and tight grip support nervousness. They suggest a feeling without proving everything about it.

Make it easier

Ask whether she is worried about a possible mistake.

Take it further

Write one action that would instead suggest excitement.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Connect a cause and result

A little hint

The dry soil is given as the reason.

Answer / what to notice

Because.

Because links the drooping to its stated cause; although would set up a contrast.

Make it easier

Say "its soil was dry, so..." first.

Take it further

Write a different sentence where although fits.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. The first word in the list

A little hint

Compare only the first letters here.

Answer / what to notice

Ant.

Ant starts with a, which comes before the other first letters.

Make it easier

Match each first letter to the shown alphabet strip.

Take it further

Put all four words in order.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. Which meaning of “light”?

A little hint

Look at the words around the uncertain word.

Answer / what to notice

Not heavy.

Carrying an empty bag points to weight, not brightness.

Make it easier

Explain both meanings before choosing.

Take it further

Write a sentence using the other meaning.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. The opposite within a sentence

A little hint

The sentence describes space, not sound.

Answer / what to notice

Wide.

Wide is the opposite of narrow when describing available width.

Make it easier

Show a narrow gap and a wide gap with your hands.

Take it further

Would quiet be a better opposite for noisy?

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. Make the owner clear

A little hint

His could point to either named person.

Answer / what to notice

No. "Omar told Sami that Sami's bike was outside."

Both people could own the bike; repeating the intended name removes this ambiguity.

Make it easier

Ask "Omar's or Sami's?" before rewriting.

Take it further

Rewrite it to mean Omar's bike instead.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. Who said the words?

A little hint

Look inside the quotation marks.

Answer / what to notice

The gate is open.

Quotation marks enclose the spoken words; Lina said identifies the speaker.

Make it easier

Use different voices for the narrator and Lina.

Take it further

Add a reply from another speaker using quotation marks.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. What happened before lunch?

A little hint

Place drawing in the middle.

Answer / what to notice

She read first.

The order is reading, drawing, then lunch, even though the passage mentions lunch before reading.

Make it easier

An adult writes the three actions on separate lines.

Take it further

Rewrite the account in time order.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. Make the subject and verb agree

A little hint

Birds means more than one.

Answer / what to notice

The birds sing.

With plural birds, the present-tense verb is sing. Sings fits one bird.

Make it easier

Compare “one bird sings” with “two birds sing”.

Take it further

Choose “The dog runs” or “The dog run” and explain.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. A heading that fits all three

A little hint

Find what all three actions are about.

Answer / what to notice

Caring for Plants.

All the details describe plant care; a heading should cover the paragraph rather than an unrelated topic.

Make it easier

Ask what is being looked after.

Take it further

Suggest a more specific heading for a paragraph only about watering.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. A comparison using “like”

A little hint

Like compares a shared quality.

Answer / what to notice

Its surface looks smooth and reflective.

The comparison describes an appearance; it does not turn the lake into a glass object.

Make it easier

Name one way a lake surface can resemble a mirror.

Take it further

Write a comparison about a cloud without claiming it is literally the other object.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. Which detail answers the question?

A little hint

When asks about time.

Answer / what to notice

It opens at nine.

The door colour and closing time are true within the passage but do not answer the opening-time question.

Make it easier

Compare only nine and blue first.

Take it further

Ask a question answered by each remaining detail.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. An instruction or a description?

A little hint

One asks the listener to take an action.

Answer / what to notice

Fold the paper once.

Fold asks for an action; the other sentence gives information about colour.

Make it easier

Act out the instruction without materials.

Take it further

Turn the colour description into an instruction involving a yellow paper.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Repair the surprising sentence

A little hint

Think about what we usually drink and eat.

Answer / what to notice

Swap drank and ate: Nour ate her sandwich and drank her water.

The actions should fit their objects in an ordinary description: eat a sandwich and drink water.

Make it easier

Fix only the sandwich part first.

Take it further

Invent another mixed-up sentence and explain how to repair it.

Another day, away from the screen

Another day, change one detail and explain whether the answer changes.